

Καρμίνα Ποπυλάρια (PMG)

Fragments of the Swallow Song and Greek Popular Verse

eul_aid: aeq

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Μικταὶ διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects](#) (frg)
Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)
Format: Συναγωγή [Collection](#)

The Carmina Popularia is not the work of a single author but a modern scholarly collection of anonymous fragments representing ancient Greek popular poetry. These oral, non-professional compositions originated across a broad period from the 7th to the 4th centuries BCE. The creators were ordinary people participating in communal activities like labor, worship, and celebration.

The collection consists of fragmentary verses categorized by type, including work songs, ritual chants, children's songs, and drinking songs. Preserved through quotations in later ancient authors, the standard modern edition is in D.L. Page's *Poetae Melici Graeci*.

These fragments provide a rare window into the non-elite, oral poetic culture of ancient Greece, offering insight into daily life, social rituals, and folk beliefs largely absent from the high literary tradition. They illustrate poetry's role in structuring communal labor and religious practice, balancing our understanding of Greek musical culture.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα τοῦ Χελιδονίου Ὠιδῶν · [Fragments of the Swallow Song](#) · 40 passages